

Sinner/Another Life

Her hands were tied hanging above her head, she could not move, not with the energy she had left. Pale yellow dress ripped apart in places, showing off her bruised skin with fresh cuts deep as it can go without killing her.

Her head usually stayed facing the floor, no one could see the faces she made, from shame maybe? Fear? It wouldn't matter anyway. Yet tonight she held it high as she could, as high to meet her gaze.

Has it been days?

Weeks?

She didn't know how long she missed those hazel eyes in front of her, watery when she should be the one crying. Instead a smile tugged her lips, the slightest euphoria she has felt in days. Two warm palms cupped her soot filled cheeks and rested their heads against each other.

"Let me free you," The girl whispered.

"They will take me, you will stay hidden in the crowd or run away but do not do this," Her throat was dry, speaking made it worse.

She asked her multiple times but it would always be a simple 'no'.

"How long?" a new question, in a long time.

"Sunrise. Leave as soon as you can before they catch you too," It was more of a plea, a cough erupted out of her rusty throat.

"Before they burn you at the stake? On my grave,"

The two palms left her cheek and hung in the air. Before she could realize, they were slowly reaching to the ropes tying her up, her body squirmed back in defense but froze.

Sunlight was already seeping through the cracks of the barn, slight footsteps turning louder.

Nabila Siddique

She could have said more, should have, before she saw the girl rushing behind a pile of hay just in time when the door burst open. Three men stood before it, red eyed with toothy grins.

“Another evil to strip off this pure land, lads,” One of the men spoke while walking towards her, the others laughed along.

The fight in her left a long time ago, though she doesn't know when. Her gaze kept straight on the ground, viewing the man's boots until her face was dragged up to his. A noise of something ruffling erupted behind the pile of hay, her heart sank and the men focused on the pile of crisp yellow.

No

The same word she uttered to her multiple times ever since the girl stepped into the barn, now she heard it on the tongue of the same girl. The same girl now trapped with one of the men, he looked like he would waste no time breaking her arms if he could.

Witch

They'd point at both of them, the men. She should have been selfish enough to escape so her arms wouldn't be tied up and neither would the girl.

Sinners

It was what they called her, it was what she was in that life. The person she loved, what she did, all a sin.

What started in the hay-filled barn did not stay in the hay-filled barn, but it ended with her neck tied up and with her body on fire.

She looked over again to see those innocent hazel eyes beside her, still watery.

“In another life, love,” She mouthed and the earth flipped over, and it was all black.